Spade



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 22 labs

Covers these lab items: Digging Spade; Garden/Digging Spade; Rabbiting Spade; Spade; Spade with wooden handle

What it is used for

A spade is used to dig, turn, and move soil in gardening and landscaping tasks. Choose a suitable spade and use controlled movements to work safely and efficiently.

How to use

1. Inspect the blade, handle, and handle joint for cracks or looseness.
2. Select a spade suitable for the soil and task.
3. Clear the work area of stones, cables, and other obstructions.
4. Hold the handle firmly and position your feet on stable ground.
5. Push the blade into the soil using controlled body movement and foot pressure where designed.
6. Lift and move manageable amounts of soil without twisting the back excessively.
7. Place the soil where required and repeat as needed.
8. Clean the blade and store the spade securely after use.

⚠ Safety

- Wear sturdy footwear and suitable gloves.
- Keep other people clear of the digging area and swing path.
- Do not use a spade with a loose handle or damaged blade.
- Check for buried utilities before digging in unfamiliar areas.

Care & storage

- Remove soil from the blade and dry it after use.
- Store the spade in a dry place and repair or replace damaged parts.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.